

Word family: **ground / grounds / grounded / grounding / groundwork**

Base word: ground

Plural: grounds

Past tense: grounded

Past participle: grounded

** -ing form:** grounding

Related form: groundwork

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related uses (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “It is what keeps people **grounded** when life becomes messy.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **grounded** means **emotionally stable, sensible, realistic, and not easily carried away by stress, pride, fear, or confusion**.

繁體中文： **保持冷靜、務實、情緒穩定，不會因壓力或混亂而失去判斷**

中文翻譯：

> “It is what keeps people **grounded** when life becomes messy.”

「當生活變得混亂時，正是這種力量令一個人保持**冷靜、務實和穩定**。」

Here:

keep someone grounded = 令某人保持理性、謙遜、務實和情緒穩定

1. **ground = surface of the earth (地面) — 地面；土地**

This is the central physical meaning.

Meaning: The solid surface of the earth that people and things stand or move on.

Practice 1

> “The bag fell to the **ground**.”

「袋子掉到**地上**。」

Practice 2

> “The children sat on the **ground**.”

「孩子們坐在**地面**上。」

ground = 地球表面的土地或地面

Common:

* fall to the ground

* lie on the ground

* ground level

* wet ground

2. **ground** = land used for a particular purpose (場地 / 土地) — 場地 ; 用地

Ground can mean land used for a specific activity.

Practice 3

> “The school has large sports **grounds**.”

「學校有很大的運動**場地**。」

Practice 4

> “The festival was held on the castle **grounds**.”

「節日在城堡的**園地 / 範圍內**舉行。」

grounds = 圍繞建築物或供特定用途使用的一大片土地

This is a related physical-land sense.

3. **ground** = reason/basis for something (理由 / 依據) — 理由 ; 根據 ; 依據

This is a major abstract meaning.

Practice 5

> “There are strong **grounds** for concern.”

「有充分的**理由 / 根據**感到擔心。」

Practice 6

> “The decision was made on legal **grounds**.”

「這項決定是基於法律**依據**作出的。」

****grounds = 支持某個決定、信念、懷疑或行動的理由 / 根據****

Common:

- * grounds for concern
- * legal grounds
- * on the grounds that...

This is genuinely distinct from physical land.

4. ****ground = area of knowledge/activity (領域) — 領域 ; 範圍****

****Ground**** can mean a subject area or field being discussed or explored.

Practice 7

> “The course covers a lot of **ground**.”

「這門課涵蓋很多**內容 / 領域**。」

Practice 8

> “We have already covered this **ground**.”

「這個**範圍 / 內容**我們已經談過了。」

****ground = 某個討論、研究或活動涉及的範圍****

This is a figurative extension of physical territory.

5. ****ground = position/base in an argument or competition (立場 / 優勢) — 立場 ; 地位 ; 陣地****

Practice 9

> “The two sides found some common ****ground****.”

「雙方找到了一些****共同立場 / 共識****。」

Practice 10

> “The company is losing ****ground**** to its competitors.”

「公司正在對競爭對手****失去優勢 / 落後****。」

****ground** = 在爭論、競爭或關係中所佔的位置、立場或優勢******

This develops from the metaphor of holding physical territory.

6. ****ground** = base/foundation (基礎) — 基礎 ; 根基******

****Ground**** can refer to the basis on which something is built or developed.

Practice 11

> “The research laid the ****ground**** for further study.”

「這項研究為進一步研究打下了****基礎****。」

Practice 12

> “Trust provides solid ****ground**** for cooperation.”

「信任為合作提供穩固的****基礎****。」

****ground** = 某件事物建立、發展或成立所依靠的基礎******

This is closely related to the “basis/reason” meaning.

For strict counting, I would often merge these under the broader ****foundation/basis**** concept.

7. ****ground** = electrical connection to earth (電學) — 接地******

In electrical contexts, ****ground**** refers to a connection with the earth or a reference point in a circuit.

Practice 13

> “The wire must be connected to **ground**.”

「這條電線必須**接地**。」

Practice 14

> “Check the **ground** connection first.”

「先檢查**接地**連接。」

ground = 電路中與大地或參考電位連接的點 / 系統

This is a specialized but common technical sense.

8. **ground** = grind into small particles (動詞 , 過去分詞形式) — 磨碎

Ground is also the past tense/past participle of **grind** in compounds such as:

> ground coffee

Practice 15

> “I bought freshly **ground** coffee.”

「我買了新鮮**磨好的**咖啡。」

Practice 16

> “The spices were finely **ground**.”

「香料被**磨得很細**。」

Important:

This **ground** is not semantically the same word family as **ground** = 地面. It is the past form of **grind**.

So for your database, it should be treated under **grind**, not under the core polysemy of **ground**.

9. ****ground** = prevent someone from flying/going out (動詞) — 禁飛；禁足******

As a verb, ****ground**** can mean preventing movement.

Practice 17

> “The storm ****grounded**** all flights.”

「暴風令所有航班****停飛****。」

Practice 18

> “His parents ****grounded**** him for a week.”

「他的父母罰他****禁足****一星期。」

****ground someone/something = 禁止其外出、飛行或繼續活動****

This is a genuinely distinct verb meaning.

10. ****ground** = base something firmly in facts/principles (動詞) — 以.....為基礎******

Practice 19

> “The argument is ****grounded in**** evidence.”

「這個論點是****以證據為基礎****的。」

Practice 20

> “Her teaching is ****grounded in**** practical experience.”

「她的教學是****以實際經驗為基礎****的。」

****be grounded in something = 建立在某種事實、原則、證據或經驗之上****

This develops directly from the ****foundation/basis**** meaning.

11. ****grounded** = sensible / emotionally stable (人格 / 情緒) — 務實的；穩重的；腳踏實地的******

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 21 — Original

> “It is what keeps people ****grounded**** when life becomes messy.”

「當生活變得混亂時，這種力量能讓人保持****冷靜、務實和穩定****。」

Practice 22

> “Despite his success, he remained ****grounded****.”

「儘管取得成功，他仍然很****腳踏實地 / 不自滿****。」

Practice 23

> “Her family helps keep her ****grounded****.”

「她的家人讓她保持****務實、穩重****。」

****grounded** = 情緒穩定、現實務實、不自大、不容易被外在變化沖昏頭腦******

This is a highly useful figurative adjective meaning.

The metaphor is:

- > physically connected to the ground
- > → mentally/emotionally stable and steady

Related form: ****grounding****

****Grounding**** can mean a basis or training that gives someone solid foundational knowledge.

Practice 24

> “The course gives students a strong ****grounding**** in basic science.”

「這門課為學生提供紮實的基礎科學****根基 / 訓練****。」

****grounding** = 讓某人在某個領域建立穩固基礎的教育或訓練******

Related form: ****groundwork****

****Groundwork**** means preparatory work that makes later development possible.

Practice 25

> “The research laid the ****groundwork**** for future discoveries.”

「這項研究為未來的發現打下了****基礎****。」

Practice 26

> “They spent months doing the ****groundwork****.”

「他們花了幾個月做前期****準備工作****。」

****groundwork** = 為日後發展、成功或進一步工作而先做的基礎準備******

Important distinction: ****ground vs floor****

****ground****

= outdoor earth surface

****floor****

= indoor walking surface of a room/building

> fall to the ground

outside.

> fall to the floor

inside.

This is an important learner distinction.

Important distinction: ****ground vs land****

****ground****

often focuses on the surface under your feet.

land

is broader and can mean territory, countryside, property, or dry earth contrasted with sea.

> wet ground

> agricultural land

Different typical uses.

Important distinction: **grounds vs reasons**

grounds

is more formal and often used in legal, official, or reasoned contexts.

> grounds for dismissal

> legal grounds

reasons

is the general everyday word.

So:

grounds = 正式依據 / 理由

reasons = 一般原因 / 理由

Important distinction: **grounded vs realistic**

realistic

means seeing situations as they really are.

grounded

often adds:

* emotional stability

* humility

* practicality

A grounded person is not merely realistic; they are also steady and sensible.

Important distinction: **grounded vs calm**

calm

= not agitated

grounded

= emotionally stable, practical, realistic, and steady

Someone can be calm for a moment without being generally grounded.

This distinction is especially relevant to your passage.

Useful expression: **common ground — 共同點；共識**

Practice 27

> “They disagreed on many things but found some **common ground**.”

「他們在很多事情上意見不同，但仍找到一些**共同點 / 共識**。」

common ground = 不同人士之間共同接受的觀點、利益或立場

Useful expression: **stand your ground — 堅守立場**

Practice 28

> “She stood her **ground** and refused to change her decision.”

「她**堅守立場**，拒絕改變決定。」

stand your ground = 面對壓力仍堅持自己的立場

This is a fixed expression rather than a new core meaning.

Useful expression: **break new ground** — 開創新領域

Practice 29

> “The research breaks new **ground**.”

「這項研究**開創了**新領域 / 取得突破。」

break new ground = 做前所未有的事情，開創新的研究、思想或活動領域

This belongs to the territory/field metaphor.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **ground**
- * **grounds**
- * **grounded**
- * **grounding**
- * **groundwork**

Useful constructions include:

- * on the ground
- * school grounds
- * grounds for something
- * common ground
- * lose ground
- * grounded in evidence
- * keep someone grounded
- * electrical ground

The Golden Manual says we should search broadly across literal, figurative, grammatical, and domain uses while still merging branches that share a genuinely unified conceptual basis.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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ground — earth surface	人或物站立、移動的地面 / 土地表面
grounds — land/premises	建築物周圍或供特定用途使用的一片土地 / 場地
grounds — reason/basis	支持決定、信念、懷疑或行動的理由 / 依據
ground — subject/territory	討論、研究、競爭或活動涉及的範圍 / 領域

ground — electrical	電路中與大地或參考電位連接的接地點 / 系統	
ground — verb, restrict movement	使航班停飛，或禁止某人外出 / 活動	
be grounded in	建立在某種事實、證據、原則或經驗之上	
grounded — personality	情緒穩定、務實、理性、不自大且腳踏實地的	
grounding	為某領域建立紮實基礎的教育 / 訓練	
groundwork	為日後發展而先做的基礎準備工作	

For your original sentence

> “It is what keeps people ****grounded**** when life becomes messy.”

The exact meaning is:

****grounded = 即使面對混亂或壓力，仍然保持冷靜、務實、理性和情緒穩定****

So:

> ****keep people grounded****

= ****令人在混亂中仍保持腳踏實地、不慌亂、不失去判斷****

For your database, I would count ****6 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****ground****:

1. ****earth surface / land****
2. ****land or premises used for a purpose****
3. ****reason / basis / foundation****
4. ****field, territory, or position in an activity/argument****
5. ****electrical ground****
6. ****verb — restrict movement, such as ground a plane/person****

I would keep ****grounded in evidence**** under #3, treat ****grounded = emotionally stable/practical**** as an important figurative family extension from the physical/foundation concept, and keep ****common ground, stand your ground, break new ground**** as fixed expressions rather than inflate the core count.